HHSL pay app: Mobile guide

Everything on your phone: install, load your rates, import your spreadsheet

Created by Akeem Silverton

The HHSL pay app tracks the days you work, works out your gross pay, PAYE, NIS and net pay, and makes your payslips and the HHSL time sheet. **Everything stays on your own phone.** There is no account and no sign-in. This guide is for doing every step **on your phone**.

Tap a part to jump to it:

[1. Install the app](#) | [2. Load your starter kit](#)
[3. Bring in your spreadsheet](#) | [4. Use it day to day](#)
[5. Set it up your way](#) | [6. Share the app](#)

The app link (tap it on your phone)

https://akeemsilver.github.io/hhsl-pay/

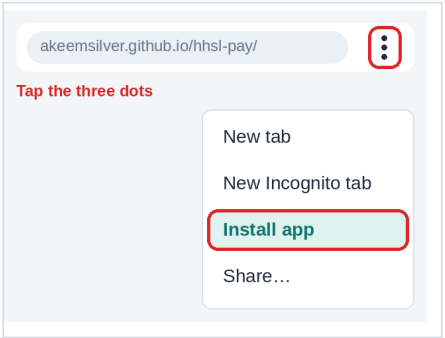
Open it in **Chrome** (Android) or **Safari** (iPhone). The pictures show how each screen looks; yours may look a little different.

Part 1. Install the app

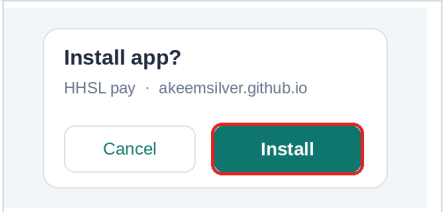
Android (Chrome)

1. Tap this link in **Chrome**: open the app. Do not open it inside WhatsApp, and do not use a private tab.

2. Tap the **three dots** at the top right, then **Install app** (or **Add to Home screen**). The app's own **Install app** button on the Home screen does the same.



3. Tap **Install**. The app icon appears on your home screen.



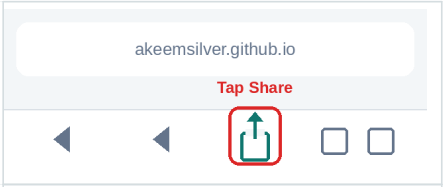
4. Open the app from this icon. It runs full screen like any other app.



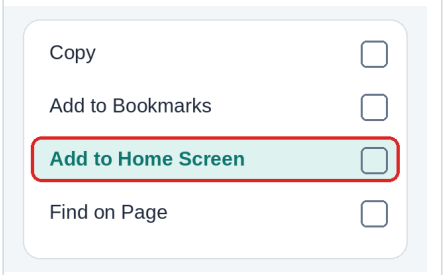
iPhone or iPad (Safari)

1. Tap this link in **Safari**: open the app.

2. Tap the **Share** button (the square with an arrow pointing up) at the bottom of the screen.



3. Scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add** at the top right.



4. Open the app from the icon on your home screen, not from Safari.



iPhone note: Safari can clear data for websites you have not opened in a while. Opening the app from its icon and making a backup now and then (Settings, Backup & restore) keeps your days safe.

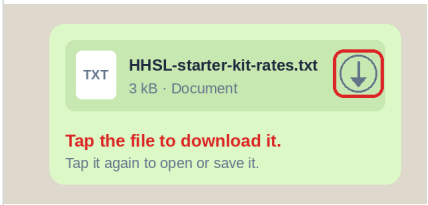
Part 2. Load your starter kit

The starter kit is a small file with the pay rates for each site, the tax rules and the time sheet form, so you do not have to type any of it in. It has **no days, no pay and no personal information**. It is sent to you as a file, and not built into the app, because the rates belong to the company and the app itself is public.

Get the file (in WhatsApp on your phone)

1. Ask the person who sent you this guide to send you the **starter kit file**, called **HHSL-starter-kit-rates.txt**, on WhatsApp.

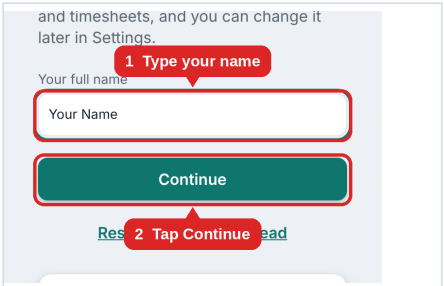
2. Open the message in WhatsApp and **tap the file** to download it. A small download arrow shows until it is saved.



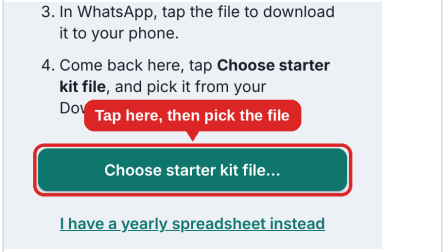
3. **iPhone only:** after it opens, tap the Share icon, then **Save to Files**, so the app can find it.

Load it into the app

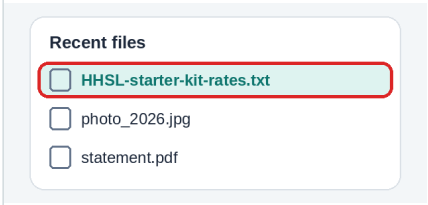
1. Open the app from its icon. Type your **full name** (it is printed on your payslips and time sheets) and tap **Continue**.



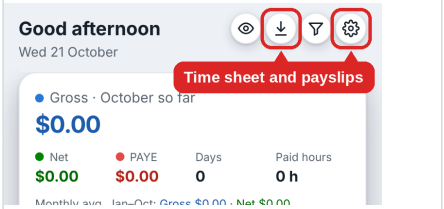
2. On the next screen, tap **Choose starter kit file**.



3. Pick **HHSL-starter-kit-rates.txt** from your **Downloads** (or **WhatsApp, Documents**). On iPhone, pick it from Files.



4. That is it. Your sites and rates are in and the Home screen opens.



File will not download or will not load?

Check that you have a signal, then tap the file in WhatsApp again, or ask for it to be sent again.

WhatsApp does not download files by itself. Tap the file once, that is normal.

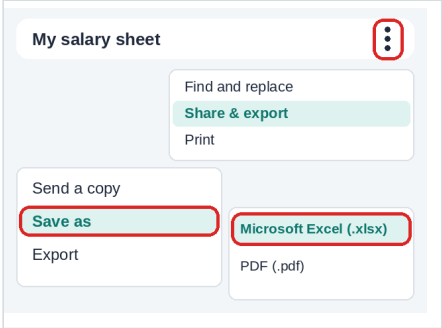
The starter kit holds company pay rates. Only pass it to colleagues.

Part 3. Bring in your spreadsheet (optional)

If you keep your days in the yearly salary spreadsheet (a tab for each month, January to December), the app can read your days from it. The app reads **Excel (.xlsx)** files, so a Google Sheet has to be saved as Excel first. You do this in the **Google Sheets app** on your phone: get it on Android or get it on iPhone.

Step A. Save your Google Sheet as Excel (in the Google Sheets app)

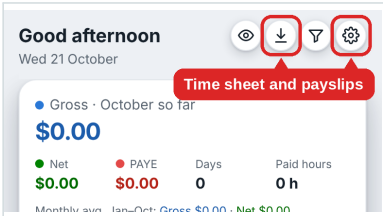
1. Open the sheet in the **Google Sheets app**. Tap the **three dots** at the top right, then **Share & export**, then **Save as**, then **Microsoft Excel (.xlsx)**.



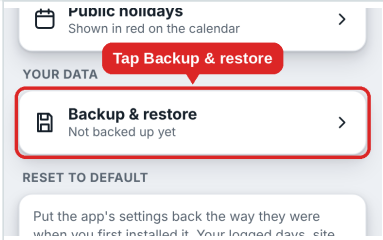
2. Choose to save it on your phone (Downloads). The file must end in **.xlsx**. A spreadsheet that is already an Excel file can skip Step A.

Step B. Import it into the app

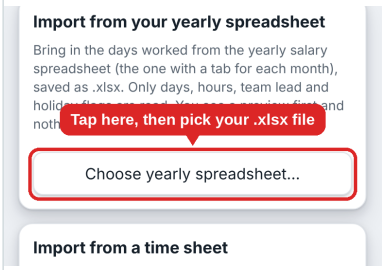
1. In the app, tap the **gear** at the top right (Settings).



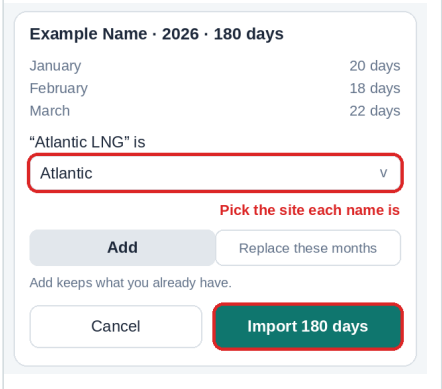
2. Scroll down and tap **Backup & restore**.



3. Under **Import from your yearly spreadsheet**, tap **Choose yearly spreadsheet** and pick your .xlsx file from Downloads.



4. A **preview** shows your name, the year and how many days were found in each month. **Nothing changes until you confirm.** For each client name in the sheet, choose which of your **sites** it is, or **Skip these days**.

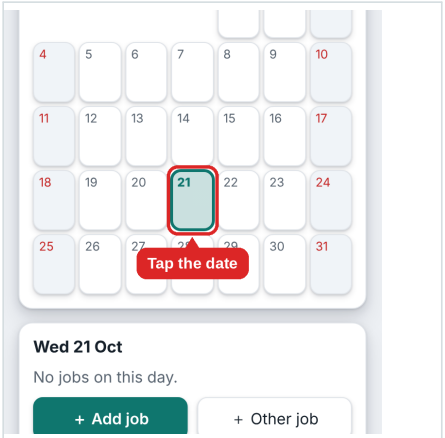


5. Choose **Add** (keeps what you already have) or **Replace these months** (clears those months first). Then tap **Import**, and open the Calendar to see your days.

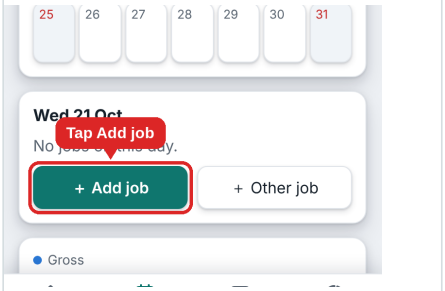
Only the days, hours, team lead and holiday flags are read. The app works out pay again from your rates, so check one month against your payslip the first time.

Part 4. Use it day to day

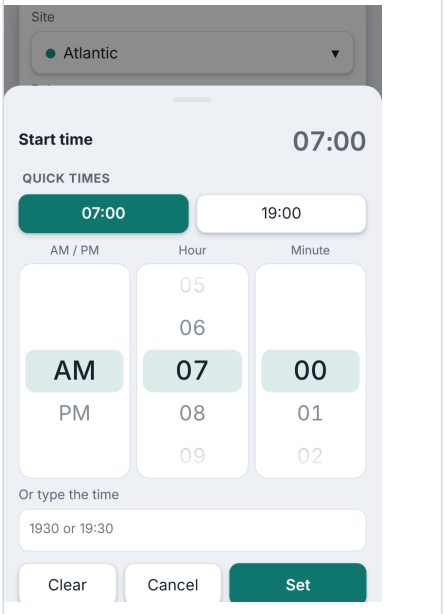
1. **Log a day:** tap **Calendar** at the bottom, then tap the date.



2. Tap **Add job**. Pick the site, then type the start and end time, or switch to **Simple** and type the hours.

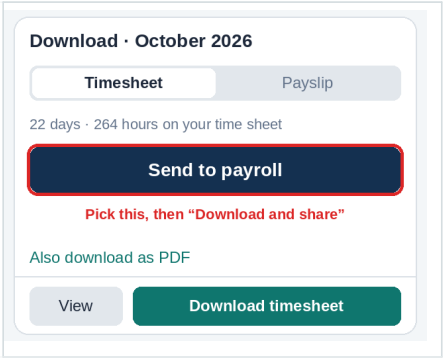


3. Tap a time to set it. Turn the three wheels (AM/PM, hour, minute) or type the time, then tap **Set**.



4. **Home** shows the month so far: gross, net, PAYE, days and paid hours, with each site underneath. Swipe the calendar left or right to change month. **Year** and **Charts** show the whole year.

5. **Time sheet:** tap the download icon at the top of any screen, choose **Send to payroll**, then **Download and share**, and pick Gmail or WhatsApp.

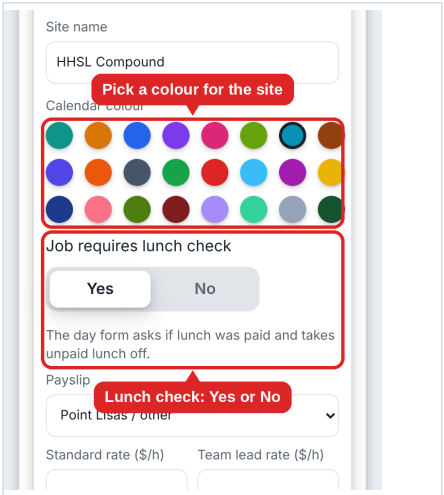


6. **Payslips:** in the same screen, switch to **Payslip**. The eye icon lets you look at them first.

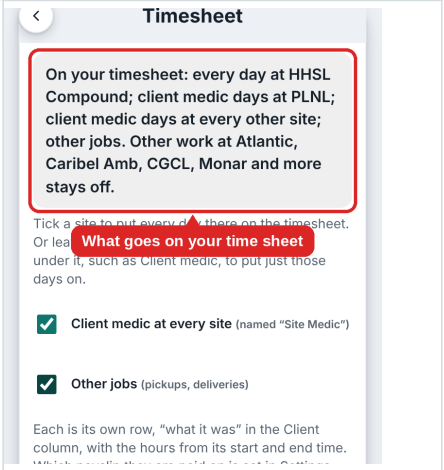
> **Back up now and then**
> Your days live only on your phone. If it is lost or its browser data is cleared, they are gone. Go to **Settings, Backup & restore** and save a backup file every month or so, somewhere safe such as Google Drive.

Part 5. Set it up your way

1. **Colour and lunch for each site:** Settings, **Site locations & rates**, open a site. Pick its calendar colour. Set **Job requires lunch check** to **No** if the site has no lunch deduction, and the day form hides the lunch options.



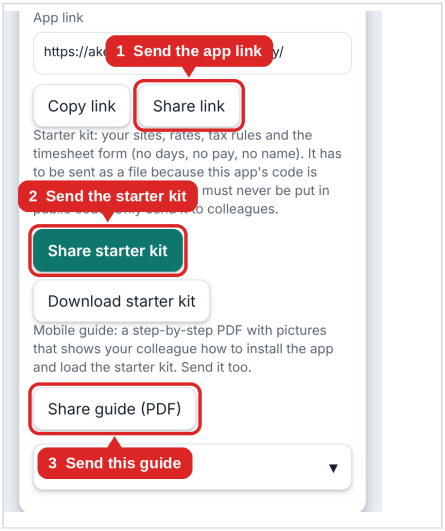
2. **Which jobs go on your time sheet:** Settings, **Timesheet**. Tick the sites and roles that go on the form. The sentence at the top reads out what is included. Press **Save**.



Part 6. Share the app with someone else

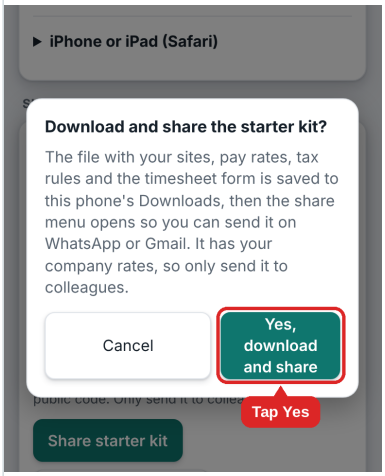
To give a colleague the app you send them **three things** on WhatsApp: **1. the app link**, **2. the starter kit file** and **3. this guide**. All three buttons are in one place in the app, and you do it all from your phone.

1. Open **Settings** (the gear) and scroll to **Share this app**. The three buttons are here.

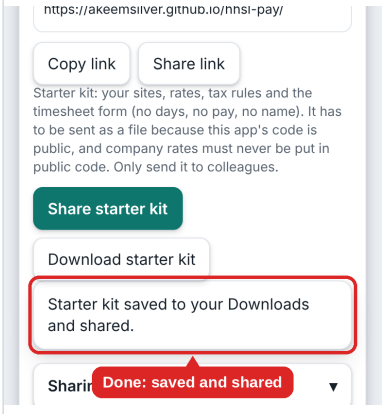


2. **Send the link.** Tap **Share link**, pick **WhatsApp** and the person.

3. **Send the starter kit.** Tap **Share starter kit**, then **Yes, download and share**.



4. The share menu opens. Pick **WhatsApp** (or Gmail) and the same person, and send the file.



5. **Send this guide.** Tap **Share guide (PDF)** and pick the same person. The guide is built into the app, so it is always the latest one. It needs a signal to load.

This guide is also here, if you ever need to download it again: HHSL-pay-app-mobile-guide.pdf

Back to the top: Part 1 · Part 2 · Part 3 · Part 4 · Part 5 · Part 6